

I Was Feeling Good and Then My Symptoms Spiked

So maybe you were having a okay moment or time in life, or stretch of time where you were feeling good, feeling better than you had felt for a while, and then your symptoms spiked. So obviously when that happens, your brain starts spinning out. 'cause it wants to know, why is this happening? I was feeling better.

Does this mean something? In my experience, it was like. Grief, it felt like something good was being taken away from me or that I was moving in the wrong direction. But it doesn't mean that this is incredibly common and a part of the desensitizing and recovery process. It does not mean you're getting worse, and it's not a sign that you did anything wrong either.

Here's what's happening. 'cause I want you to understand it a little bit. Like your nervous system has been on alert for way long, such a long time that it's to the point now where even feeling good is unfamiliar to your nervous system. So when you bring into your life relaxation or enjoyment, or letting your guard down a little bit, these things can feel threatening to a sensitized system.

Kind of imagine your brain is saying, wait, if we're not scanning for danger, something must be wrong. So it spikes symptoms, it throws new symptoms at you, and it does. It's not because anything is wrong, it's just because calm is feeling unsafe to your nervous system right now. It's, it's feeling like another threat.

And what happens when the threat system goes on? The alarms go on. So the worst thing that you can do right now is let it ruin the experience that you're having or the good stretch of time that you've been experiencing. If you stop what you were doing or what you're doing now, and you withdraw and you start analyzing why this happened, you're teaching your nervous system that enjoyment is dangerous.

So don't do that. We can acknowledge the spike. Yes, this is what is here for you now. And then you stay with it. You keep doing what you were doing. You don't change your schedule around you just let the symptoms be very loud in the background while you continue whatever it is you're involved with in your life.

You don't have to feel good to keep going. You can still feel terrible and be present. The symptoms can come with you and how you respond in these moments does start to impact how quickly they move through. The more we freak out, in my experience, the more. The symptoms stay. Even when you're having these periods of feeling better and feeling worse, you'll start to notice that things begin to pass through really quickly.

So stick with this long enough to see that happen. This is how you teach your nervous system, that good moments and feeling safe is safe. It's not by having symptom-free experiences and never experiencing a symptom ever again. It's by learning to stay in the experience even when the symptoms show up. So stay in the moment and let it be messy because that is the work.